

Native American Cultures

1491

Essential Question: Explain how and why various native populations in the period before European contact interacted with the natural environment in North America

Native populations interacted with the natural environment through practices of hunting, gathering and farming. They farmed crops such as corn, beans and squash. Some tribes were nomadic hunter/gatherers, following herds and moving with the seasons.

- There are 156 distinct ethnic groups in the Americas (N and S)

American Indian culture groups:

- Arctic
- Plains Indians
- Northeast / Great Lakes
- Southwest
- Southeast

Arctic Indians:

- Eskimo seal hunters
- Hunting, gathering and fishing

Plains Indians:

- Bison Hunters
- Migratory housing (Teepees)
- Horses
- Nomadic (synonym of migratory) peoples, meaning that they roam around to find resources

Northeast / Great Lakes

- Plains Indian bison hunts
- Hunting and gathering
- Slash and burn agriculture
 - Types of crop “Three Sisters” (Corn, Squash, Beans)
- The Iroquois lived in longhouses
 - Made from the abundant supply of wood (Plentiful forests nearby)
 - Settled populations
- Gender Roles:
 - Women generally shared in labor, except in hunting

Southwest (Hopi, Pueblo)

- Extremely hot, dry weather
- Clay houses
- Cliff dwellings
- Grew corn (Maize) for food

Southeast (Cherokee, Creek)

- Agriculture
- Settled Communities
- Mississippian Cultures (Cahokia, Mound)